INCH-POUND

MIL-R-44473
4 August 1993

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

RICE, ORIENTAL STYLE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers oriental style rice, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification for
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M. Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 301-391)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

United States Standards for Milled Rice

(Copies are available from the Federal Grain Inspection Service, Animal and Plant Health Inspection, Printing and Distribution Section, G-100 Federal Building, Hyattsville, MD 20782.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, One Maritime Plaza, 23rd Floor, San Francisco, CA 94111.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First Article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Rice, long grain, parboiled. Rice shall be parboiled, long grain, milled rice, U.S. No. 2 or better of the U.S. Standards for Milled Rice and be of varieties which are suitable for canning. The rice shall contain not more than 2 percent of kernels having white, ungelatinized areas. Also, the rice shall contain not less than 10 percent nor more than 15 percent moisture (see 6.4.1).

3.2.2 Celery, fresh. Celery shall be fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems, and damage.

3.2.3 Water chestnuts, sliced, canned. The canned, sliced water chestnuts shall have been packed in water. The color of the canned water chestnuts shall be off-white and the slice thickness shall be 0.1 to 0.2 inches. The water chestnuts shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.4 Ham, canned or cooked. The canned or cooked ham shall not be labeled "water added", and shall not contain dextrose or smoke flavoring. The canned or cooked ham shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28°F to 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 60 days from date of pack until preparation of the finished product.

3.2.5 Soy sauce. The soy sauce shall have been prepared from water, wheat, soybeans, and salt. The soy sauce shall contain not more than 0.10 percent sodium benzoate as a preservative and shall have a titratable acidity of not less than 0.95 percent or more than 1.15 percent. The flavor shall be

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tart, sweet, salty, with a definite, fermented bouquet. The soy sauce shall be a clear, reddish-brown color with no, visual impurities. The soy sauce shall be of the latest date of pack (see 6.4.2).

3.2.6 Oil, vegetable. Vegetable oil shall possess a clean, bland flavor, and shall have a minimum stability of 15 hours (A.O.M.), a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.05 percent, a moisture/volatile matter content not to exceed 0.06 percent and pass a cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.7 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated, chopped onions shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.8 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride, with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Pepper, white, ground. Ground, white pepper shall be derived from the dried, mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor, and a light color. The ground, white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground, white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.10 Water. Water used for blanching, formulation and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of the rice. The rice shall be prepared using the following steps:

a. The rice shall be placed in an excess quantity of 190°F to 200°F water and blanched until the rice weighs approximately two times its original, dry weight. Note: The blanching process must be carefully controlled in order to meet the finished product, moisture content requirement.

b. The blanched rice shall be thoroughly rinsed with clean, cool water to remove all excess, rice starch.

c. The blanched, rinsed rice shall be thoroughly drained.

3.3.2 Preparation of ham. The ham shall be diced into 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (± 1/16 inch) dices. The dices shall be blanched to produce a 25 to 30

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percent cook-out of broth without scorching the ham dices. If the blanched, ham dices are not immediately utilized in the product, the dices shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28°F to 40°F for not more than 48 hours from the time of dicing to product preparation.

3.3.3 Preparation of fresh celery. The fresh celery shall be cleaned thoroughly, trimmed to remove fibrous, longitudinal strands and sliced in 3/8 inch, cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The sliced celery shall be blanched in 180°F to 190°F water for one minute. The blanched celery shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into the tray pack can within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.4 Product preparation. The product shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by Weight
Rice, long grain, parboiled, blanched	61.72
Celery, fresh, blanched	9.00
Water chestnuts, sliced, canned, drained	9.00
Ham dices, blanched	7.00
Soy sauce	6.75
Oil, vegetable	4.50
Onions, dehydrated, chopped	1.75
Salt 1/	0.20
Pepper, white, ground	0.08

1/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product, salt requirements (see 3.6).

a. The vegetable oil shall be combined with the blanched rice and mixed sufficiently to coat the rice grains with the oil.

b. The remaining ingredients shall be combined with the coated rice and mixed only to the degree necessary to ensure compliance with the finished product requirements (see 3.6).

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Immediately after filling, each can shall be sealed in accordance with the can manufacturer's guidelines/requirements and 21 CFR, Part 113, Subpart D, or 9 CFR, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable (see 4.5.5), and under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to ensure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6.o).

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b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within two hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less that 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements.

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour or stale.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 98 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 96 ounces of product.

f. The salt content of any individual can shall be not less than 0.5 percent nor greater than 1.5 percent.

g. The rice shall be dark tan to light brown in color.

h. Texture of rice shall not be hard, mushy, or pasty.

i. Appearance of rice shall be slightly fluffy with distinct, uniform rice grains.

j. The moisture content shall be not less than 58 percent or not greater than 63 percent.

k. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

l. The sample average fat content shall be not greater than 6.0 percent.

m. The fat content of the product in any individual can shall be not greater than 8.0 percent.

n. The finished product shall contain a uniform distribution of ingredients.

o. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

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3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant Qualifications. The ham component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of the referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer,

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and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight examination. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 98 ounces or the net weight of any individual can is less than 96 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Double sampling plan for product inspection. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be expressed in tray pack cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tray pack can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects. The sample cans shall be heated in accordance with the heating instructions on the can label.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Texture of rice hard, mushy, or pasty
102		Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
103		Ingredients not uniformly distributed throughout the product
	201	Color of rice not dark tan to light brown
	202	Appearance of rice not slightly fluffy with distinct, uniform rice grains

1/ The presence of any foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, methods 960.39 and for salt content in accordance with method 935.47, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened tray pack cans shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.3.4 Moisture content testing. Using the prepared samples from each of the three tray packs tested for fat and salt (see 4.5.3.3), an analysis for moisture content shall be performed in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 925.45. The test shall be performed with the addition of sand for a total of five hours. The results shall be calculated as percent moisture and reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any test result lower than 58 percent or greater than 63 percent (see 3.6) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall

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be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, scratches, scuffs, or abrasions that occur on the outside coating as a result of the filling, sealing, and thermoprocessing of the tray cans shall not be scored as a defect.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closures shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's guidelines/requirements and 21 CFR, Part 113, Subpart D, or 9 CFR, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75°F ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape
Dimensions of pads not as specified
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified

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Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with Level A.

5.1.1 Level A. Ninety-eight ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with an HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced with tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 or PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two

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cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of class domestic, grade 175 fiberboard.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three letter code identifying the establishment
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four-digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1990, would be coded as 0078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sublotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four-digit Julian code. Following the four-digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above. In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 end of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.5.4.1 after preparation of the product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements.

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 40 to 45 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

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TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 50 to 60 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 2/3 cup each.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002 inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack cans shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT
OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE,
UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory).

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

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6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Ingredient information.

6.4.1 Rice. It has been found that Uncle Ben's Parboiled, Converted Rice, Uncle Ben's, Inc., Houston, TX, and Riviana Parboiled PB-S, Riviana Foods, Inc., Houston, TX, meet the requirements of 3.2.1 and perform satisfactorily in this product.

6.4.2 Soy sauce. It has been found that Soy Sauce, Product Code 00610, manufactured by Kikkoman International, P.O. Box 784, San Francisco, CA 94101 meets the requirements of 3.2.4 and performs satisfactorily in this product. The 5.75 percent by weight of soy sauce in the formula was based on the titratable acidity requirements specified in 3.2.5. The tray pack oriental style rice, producer is cautioned to verify the titratable acidity requirement prior to product formulation.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Rations
Shelf stable

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-A734)

Review Activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-R-44473	1993 August 4

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

RICE, ORIENTAL STYLE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (if applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON/DSN
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-4501	256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WTP Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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